

MARKET SURVEY:

Training Sector Seeing Rising Demand for New Subjects



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With ever-changing technologies and expectations of a smarter work force for best results, training is viewed as a skill accelerator tool rather than an additional expense incurred. Aspirants looking to study abroad to pursue a masters degree are also enrolling in training institutes to specialise in their area of interest. Industry experts feel that this will help them in selecting the right courses and modules, and screen universities. It will also help them in preparing a good

statement of purpose. Engineering graduates too can opt for specialised courses at training institutes to supercharge their skills and land up with the right job profile, depending on their area of interest.

With the aim to achieve the best possible results from employees, companies also offer training in newer areas to their existing workforce, to help them boost their skills, eventually leading to the company's growth.

Let us take a look at the current demand trends in training courses for professionals and graduates, with respect to the electronics industry. We also emphasise on some emerging business models, new courses and geographic trends, while highlighting the scenario in the training field.

Importance of tying up with industry

"We have partnered with companies like Freescale, ARM and STMicroelectronics, and are also a member of India Electronics & Semiconductor Association (IESA). This helps us in staying in sync with current trends and demands in the industry. It also helps us design our curriculum accordingly."

—**Jayant Kaintura, head - learning and development, Tevatron Technologies**
"It is very important for a training institute to tie up with semiconductor and electronics companies. It gives the training institute brand recognition in society. It also helps us to stay in touch with current happenings in the industry and make sure courses never become outdated and meet the requirements of the industry as well."

—**Venkatesh Prasad, CEO, RV-VLSI**

Point of view: The training products sector

Latest demand trends. We cater to all engineering colleges, polytechnics and defence training establishments across the country. Army, Navy and Air Force have their own training centres.

In defence training establishments, there is demand for simulators. Air Force requires different parts of an aircraft to be supplied as simulators, such as landing gear system simulator or cockpit simulator, so that trainees can have first-hand training before they move on to the real aircraft.

In engineering colleges, demand of training mostly depends on the syllabus. Whenever there is a revision in the syllabus of the university, upgraded training products are accordingly provided. For instance, this year some engineering colleges have introduced DSP training kits and microcontroller projects.

New product segments. Only a revision in syllabus will give rise to new products and segments. If we develop a training product out of an educational university's syllabus, it is difficult for us to supply. Only a handful of engineering colleges demand for products that are not necessarily part of their syllabus; probably for high-level projects.

Made in India. From basic concept development to circuit design, fabrication and testing, all training products that we supply are made in-house. At the component level, we do import some of these.

—**K. Vijayasree, general manager, Lab Electronics**

Changing trends and new courses

Technology is constantly changing. Hence, it is important for professionals and graduates to expand and upgrade their existing skills. To meet and keep up to date with demand, training institutes also look to revise the curriculum of their courses on a regular basis.

The trend is to make programs specific to the demand of the industry. Jayant Singh Kaintura, head - learning and development, Tevatron Technologies, says, "We focus on introducing courses based on the current scenario of the industry." He adds, "This year, we have introduced specialised training [courses] on drone surveillance systems, STM 32-bit ARM processors, system verilog certificate course in functional verification, Internet of Things (IoT) and computer-aided design (CAD)."

Venkatesh Prasad, CEO, RV-VLSI, says, "The change in demand, from our perspective, is that, we are starting to see a lot of interest in the industry for back-end courses. By back-end I mean full-custom physical intellectual property (IP) development such as standard cells, memory layout and